

Publish, not Perish: A Common-Sense Guide to Understanding Scholarly Impact Metrics

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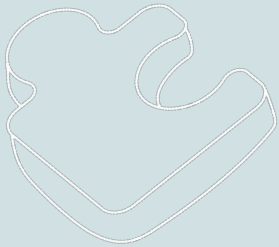


Agenda

1. What are scholarly metrics?
2. Why are they important?
3. Understanding different kinds of metrics
4. Problematizing visibility, impact, and prestige
5. Common sense tips for moving forward
6. Libraries Resources



1. What are scholarly metrics?



Scholarly metrics measure the impact of your work.

Research/ scholarly impact is the demonstrable contribution that research makes to academia and society.



There are two general ways of extrapolating your impact:

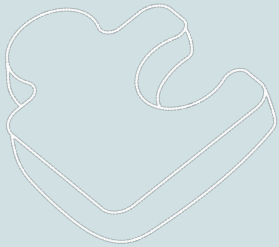


Individual



Journal

2. Why are scholarly metrics important?



Why is impact important?

1. An attempt to show benefit to your field
2. Strengthen your case when you apply for promotion or tenure
3. Quantify return on research investment for grant renewals and progress reports
4. Strengthen future funding requests by showing value of your research
5. Identify who is using your work and confirm that it is appropriately credited
6. Identify collaborators within or outside of your subject area



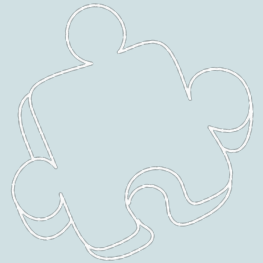
Having an impact
starts with
maximizing visibility

Maximize Visibility

1. Publish Open Access or post a version of your work on an institutional repository
2. Network and publicize your research on social media and other services such as X (Twitter) and Kudos.
3. Share your data.
4. Evaluate and select where to publish based on reputation, circulation, etc.
5. Share an early version (pre-print) of your paper



3. Understanding different impact metrics



Start Simple

Sometimes simple is the most direct

Before getting to more complicated metrics, start with:

- Citation counts
- Downloads
- Views
- And Qualitative Feedback

Impact Factor

AKA Journal Impact Factor
(JIF)

A = the number of times articles published in 2022 and 2023 were cited by indexed journals during 2024.

B = the total number of "citable items" published in 2022 and 2023.

$A/B = \text{JIF for 20}$

[Journal Citation Reports](#)

Impact Factor

AKA Journal Impact Factor
(JIF)

2.5

=

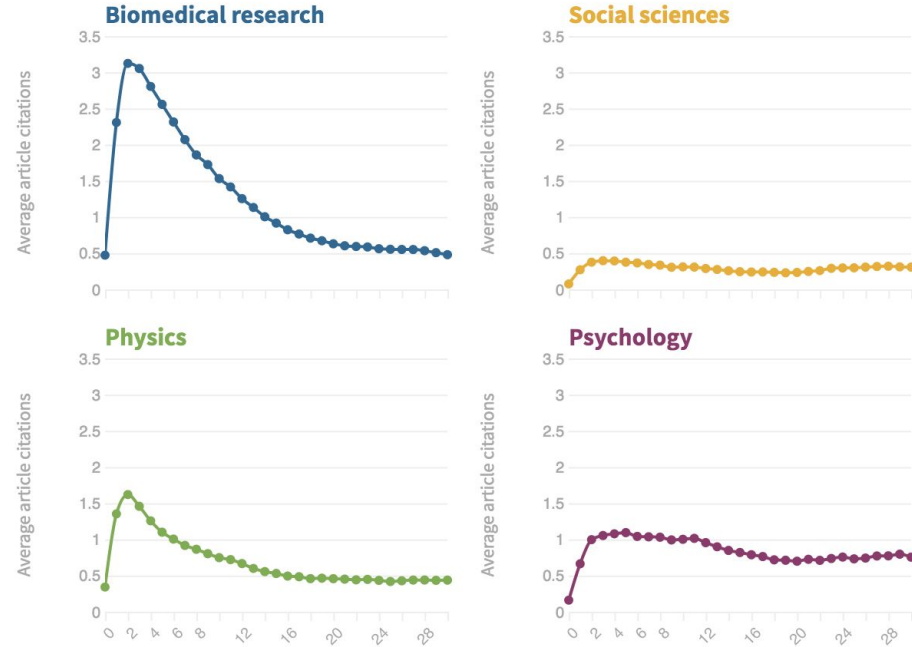
in the indexed year each article
published was cited on average 2.5
times in the previous two years in that
journal.

Impact Factor

What's Wrong in 5 Graphs

<https://www.natureindex.com/news-blog/whats-wrong-with-the-jif-in-five-graphs>

Varied citation rates across fields

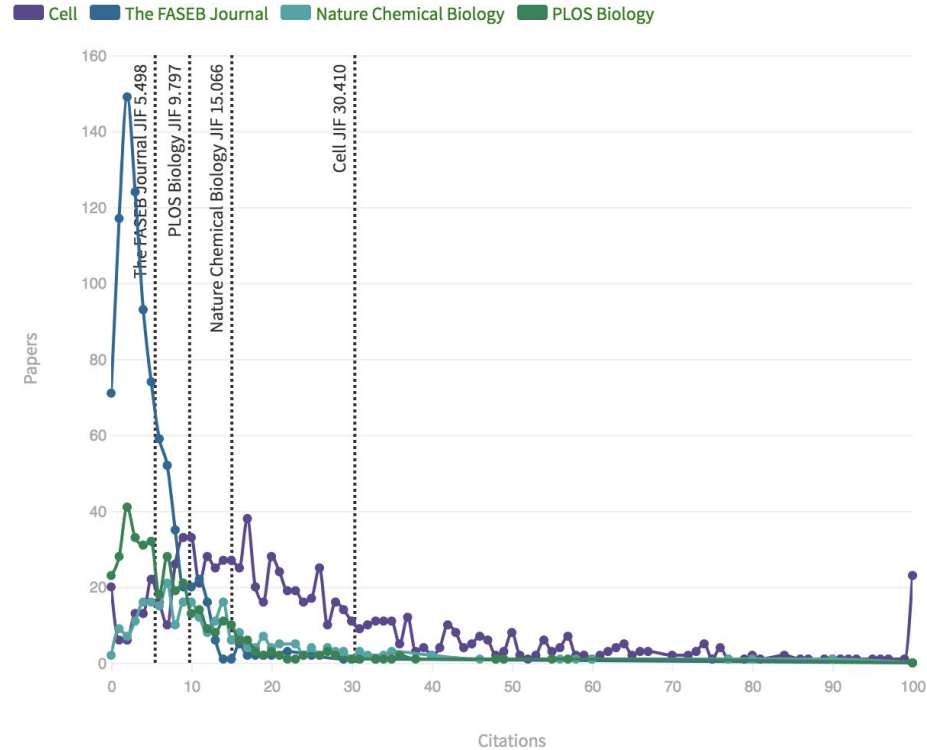


Impact Factor

What's Wrong in 5 Graphs

<https://www.natureindex.com/news-blog/whats-wrong-with-the-jif-in-five-graphs>

Not all papers are cited equally

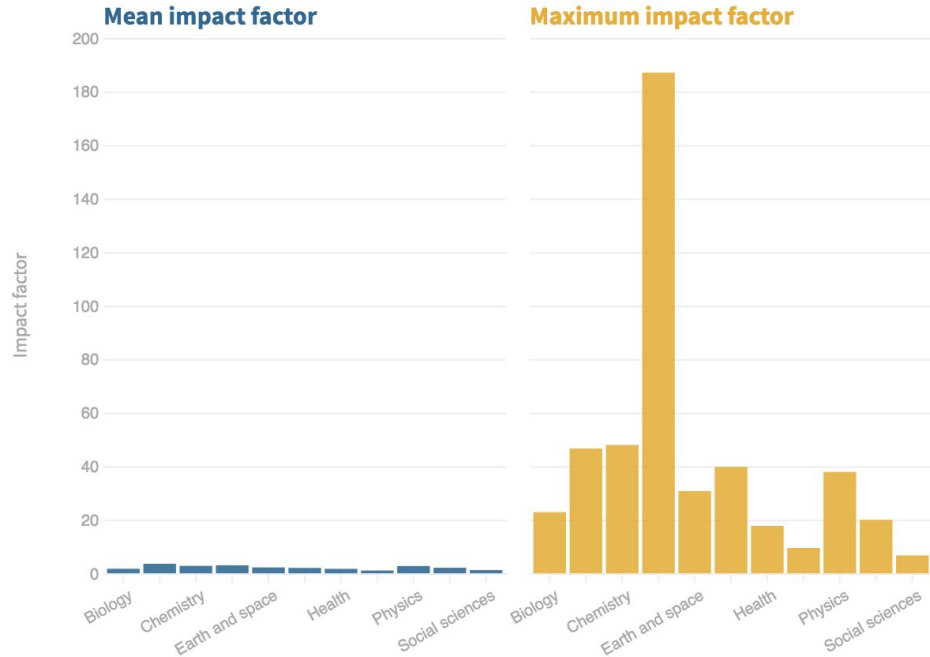


Impact Factor

What's Wrong in 5 Graphs

<https://www.natureindex.com/news-blog/whats-wrong-with-the-jif-in-five-graphs>

JIF cannot be used to compare
across disciplines

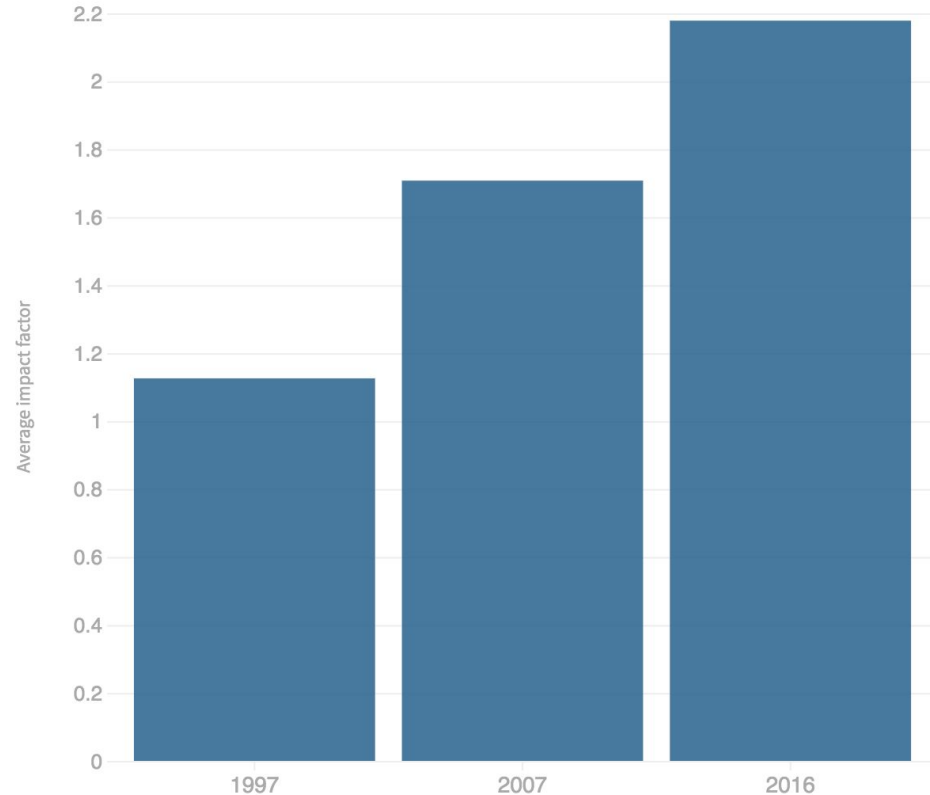


Impact Factor

What's Wrong in 5 Graphs

<https://www.natureindex.com/news-blog/whats-wrong-with-the-jif-in-five-graphs>

The JIF is inflating...



Other Journal Citation Factors

[Eigenfactor](#)

[SCImago](#)

Both are network based citation metrics

[SNIP: Source Normalized Impact per Paper](#)

Based on Scopus; corrects for field differences and contextualizes

H-index

Calculates the impact of a person by attempting to measure both the scientific productivity and the apparent scientific impact of a researcher

To Find h-index:

List Publications in descending order by times cited.

H = the number of papers (N) in the list that have N or more citations.

H-index

Publication		Times Cited
1	-----	87
2	-----	70
3	-----	46
4	-----	32
5	-----	19
6	-----	15
7	-----	10
8	-----	9
9	-----	8
10	-----	6
11	-----	4
12	-----	1

Cut-off

<https://researchguides.uic.edu/c.php?g=252299&p=1683205>
<https://www.muhclibraries.ca/training-and-consulting/guides-and-tutorials/whats-your-impact-calculating-your-h-index/>

Other Author Impact Measures

G-index

i10-index



Altmetrics

Measuring Mentions

Tracks mentions of research on a variety of social and Internet platforms: News, blogs, Facebook, YouTube, Wikipedia, Mendeley, etc.

Recognizes importance of **public engagement**

Altmetric Explorer for Faculty and Staff

4. Visibility / Impact / Prestige



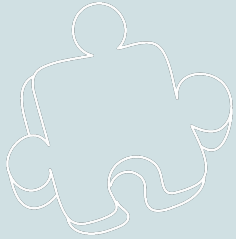


What are we really trying to calculate by measuring visibility and impact?



Both are proxies for
Prestige

5. Common sense tips





Don't miss the forest for the trees



Think critically about how
Open vs. Closed access
will factor into your overall
publishing strategy

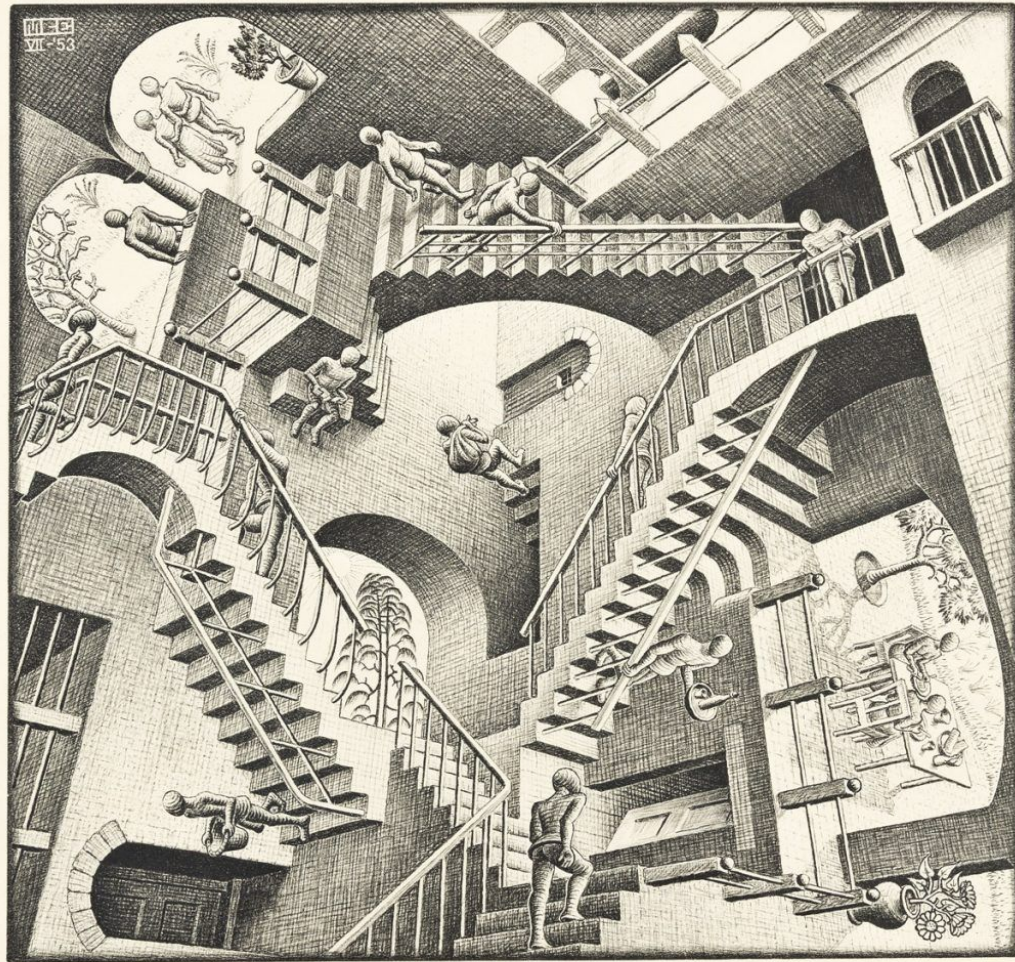
Me who thought
about publication
venues and author's
rights ahead of time

Impact of my
work



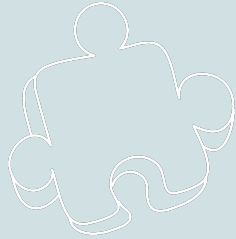
Visibility is important, but it
doesn't work unless your
strategy works for you!





Ideas about prestige and
impact are constantly
being constructed...and
deconstructed

6. Some Libraries Resources



Funding for:

1. Open Access monographs
2. Open Access journal publications
 - a. See eligibility criteria
3. Articles through publishers with institutional agreements with CU Boulder

Support/infrastructure for:

1. Publishing your data sets in CU Scholar and receiving DataCite DOIs
2. Finding repositories and open publishing options in your discipline
3. Hosting open access journals (we currently host both faculty- and student-run journals)
4. Creating your academic online presence
5. Utilizing and understanding scholarly impact indicators, such as h-index and altmetrics

<https://scholar.colorado.edu/>

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What's wrong with woke ads? An analysis of trans resistance movements and corporate co-optation

Creator: Thomas, Ceiteirein

Subject: no subject specified

Resource Type: Undergraduate Honors Thesis

Kaleidoscopic Inquiries: Queering Approaches to Organizational Diversity Work

Creator: Kenney, Sean



Pendulum New Music



Peter G. Ossorio Collection

Other repositories for sharing

Subject Repositories



Physics, Math, Computer
Science, etc.



American Literature,
Musicology, etc.



Social Sciences



Psychology, Neuroscience,
Philosophy, Biology, etc.

General Repositories



Open Science
Framework



Registry of data
repositories

Thank you!

Comments? Questions?

Slides posted @ <https://osf.io/36mj4/>



General Questions:
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